

THE PAPER 3: WEIMAR AND NAZI GERMANY, 1918-39 DOSSIER: KEY TOPIC 1: THE WEIMAR REPUBLIC

84 Crucial Questions. Complete Knowledge Mastery.

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- ☐ **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- ☐ **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- ☐ **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

KT1.1: The Origins of the Republic, 1918–1919

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	What was the financial impact of WWI on Germany's national debt by 1918?	☐	☐	☐	
2	How many German civilians died from food shortages caused by the British naval blockade?	☐	☐	☐	
3	What event occurred at a naval base in late October 1918 that sparked a nationwide revolution?	☐	☐	☐	
4	On what exact date did Kaiser Wilhelm II abdicate?	☐	☐	☐	
5	Where did Kaiser Wilhelm II flee to after his abdication?	☐	☐	☐	
6	Who proclaimed the new German Republic from the balcony of the Reichstag?	☐	☐	☐	
7	Who became the first Chancellor (and later first President) of the Weimar Republic?	☐	☐	☐	
8	What was the name of the temporary government set up by Ebert until elections could be held?	☐	☐	☐	
9	On what exact date was the Armistice signed?	☐	☐	☐	
10	Which German politician signed the Armistice on behalf of the Republic?	☐	☐	☐	
11	What insulting term was given to the politicians who signed the Armistice by right-wing nationalists?	☐	☐	☐	
12	What is the German term for the 'stab-in-the-back' myth?	☐	☐	☐	
13	Why did the new politicians meet in Weimar in 1919 rather than the capital, Berlin?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
14	Under the Weimar Constitution, what was the voting age?	☐	☐	☐	
15	What was the specific name of the voting system used to elect the Reichstag?	☐	☐	☐	
16	How frequently was the President of the Weimar Republic elected?	☐	☐	☐	
17	Under the Constitution, how many votes did a party need to gain exactly one seat in the Reichstag?	☐	☐	☐	
18	Why did Proportional Representation create weak governments?	☐	☐	☐	
19	What was Article 48?	☐	☐	☐	
20	What was the name of the upper house of parliament that represented the 18 German regions (Länder)?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT1.1: The Origins of the Republic, 1918–1919

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	List the ways in which a major conflict like the First World War might weaken a country's government and economy.	☐	☐	☐	
22	Define: What is an 'autocracy', and who held this absolute power in Germany before 1918?	☐	☐	☐	
23	Recall: What were the typical beliefs and policies of extreme left-wing and right-wing political groups in the early 20th century?	☐	☐	☐	
24	15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about what you already know regarding Germany's defeat in the First World War.	☐	☐	☐	
25	On what exact date was the Treaty of Versailles signed?	☐	☐	☐	
26	What was Article 231 of the Treaty of Versailles?	☐	☐	☐	
27	How much was Germany ordered to pay in reparations in 1921?	☐	☐	☐	
28	Under the Treaty, what was the maximum number of soldiers allowed in the German army?	☐	☐	☐	
29	What German term was used to describe the Treaty of Versailles, meaning a 'dictated peace'?	☐	☐	☐	
30	Who were the two main leaders of the Spartacist League?	☐	☐	☐	
31	What political ideology did the Spartacists follow?	☐	☐	☐	
32	In what month and year did the Spartacist Uprising take place?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
33	Who did Chancellor Ebert use to violently crush the Spartacist Uprising?	☐	☐	☐	
34	Who were the Freikorps?	☐	☐	☐	
35	In what month and year did the Kapp Putsch take place?	☐	☐	☐	
36	Why did the Kapp Putsch begin?	☐	☐	☐	
37	Why did the regular German army refuse to stop the Kapp Putsch?	☐	☐	☐	
38	How did the Weimar government successfully defeat the Kapp Putsch?	☐	☐	☐	
39	Why did French and Belgian troops invade the Ruhr in January 1923?	☐	☐	☐	
40	What non-violent tactic did the German government order the Ruhr workers to use against the French?	☐	☐	☐	

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KT1.2: Early Challenges to the Republic, 1919–1923

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	Why did the invasion of the Ruhr directly lead to hyperinflation?	☐	☐	☐	
42	By November 1923, how much did a single loaf of bread cost in Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
43	Which specific social class was hit the hardest by hyperinflation, and why?	☐	☐	☐	
44	Name one group of people who actually benefited (were 'winners') during the hyperinflation crisis.	☐	☐	☐	
45	Who became Chancellor in August 1923 and is widely credited with saving the Weimar Republic?	☐	☐	☐	
46	What was the name of the temporary currency introduced by Stresemann in November 1923?	☐	☐	☐	
47	What was the Rentenmark tied to in order to restore public confidence in its value?	☐	☐	☐	
48	What permanent, gold-backed currency replaced the temporary one in 1924?	☐	☐	☐	
49	In what year was the Dawes Plan agreed?	☐	☐	☐	
50	Under the Dawes Plan, which country agreed to loan Germany 800 million gold marks?	☐	☐	☐	
51	What was the primary economic danger of the Dawes Plan for the Weimar Republic?	☐	☐	☐	
52	What was the name of the 1929 economic plan that reduced total reparations?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
53	How much was the reparations bill reduced to under the Young Plan?	☐	☐	☐	
54	What diplomatic treaty did Germany sign in 1925, agreeing to its new western borders?	☐	☐	☐	
55	Why was the Locarno Pact viewed so differently by Germans compared to the Treaty of Versailles?	☐	☐	☐	
56	In what year was Germany allowed to join the League of Nations?	☐	☐	☐	
57	What position was Germany given within the League of Nations to show it was a 'great power' again?	☐	☐	☐	
58	What was the Kellogg-Briand Pact of 1928?	☐	☐	☐	
59	How many seats did the Nazi Party win in the 1928 Reichstag election, highlighting the drop in extremist support?	☐	☐	☐	
60	Who was elected as President of the Weimar Republic in 1925 following the death of Friedrich Ebert?	☐	☐	☐	

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KT1.3: The Recovery of the Republic, 1924–1929

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	Which two groups in German society did not experience prosperity during the Golden Age?	☐	☐	☐	
62	During the 'Golden Age', what was the lowest number of unemployed people in Germany, showing underlying economic weakness?	☐	☐	☐	
63	What was Stresemann's famous quote warning about the fragility of the German economy?	☐	☐	☐	
64	What major global economic event happened in October 1929, just weeks after Stresemann died?	☐	☐	☐	
65	By what percentage did 'real wages' for German workers rise between 1925 and 1928?	☐	☐	☐	
66	What major welfare law was passed in 1927 to protect workers?	☐	☐	☐	
67	What percentage of a worker's wage was deducted to fund the 1927 Unemployment Insurance Act?	☐	☐	☐	
68	How many new homes were built between 1925 and 1929 to solve the housing crisis?	☐	☐	☐	
69	Which specific clause in the Weimar Constitution guaranteed women equal rights with men?	☐	☐	☐	
70	How many female deputies were in the Reichstag by 1926?	☐	☐	☐	
71	What insulting term was used by traditionalists to describe married women who held jobs?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
72	By 1933, how many female teachers were there in Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
73	What term was used by the media to describe young, independent, fashion-conscious women in the 1920s?	☐	☐	☐	
74	Give two reasons why a cultural explosion occurred in 1920s Germany.	☐	☐	☐	
75	What was the name of the new movement in art that painted the gritty reality of everyday German life?	☐	☐	☐	
76	Name two famous German artists associated with the New Objectivity movement.	☐	☐	☐	
77	What was the name of the revolutionary school of design and architecture founded in Weimar Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
78	Who was the founder of the Bauhaus movement?	☐	☐	☐	
79	What was the guiding principle or slogan of the Bauhaus school?	☐	☐	☐	
80	Who directed the groundbreaking 1927 science-fiction film Metropolis?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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Date: _____

KT1.4: Changes in Society, 1924–1929

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
81	Which German actress became a global film superstar during the Weimar era?	☐	☐	☐	
82	Why did right-wing groups and the Nazi Party despise the cultural changes of the 1920s?	☐	☐	☐	
83	Why did extreme left-wing groups (Communists) criticise the cultural explosion?	☐	☐	☐	
84	Which social class deeply resented the improvements made for the working classes because they had not recovered their own lost savings?	☐	☐	☐	

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THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

KT1.1: The Origins of the Republic, 1918–1919

1. It tripled from 50 billion marks to 150 billion marks
2. Approximately 750,000
3. The mutiny of German sailors at Kiel
4. 9 November 1918
5. Holland
6. Philipp Scheidemann
7. Friedrich Ebert
8. The Council of People's Representatives
9. 11 November 1918
10. Matthias Erzberger
11. The November Criminals
12. Dolchstoßlegende
13. Berlin was too violent and unstable due to ongoing political rioting
14. All men and women over the age of 20
15. Proportional Representation
16. Every 7 years
17. 60,000 votes
18. It meant no single party ever won a majority, forcing weak 'coalition' governments
19. A constitutional clause allowing the President to bypass the Reichstag and rule by emergency decree
20. The Reichsrat
21. A major conflict drains government finances through massive war debts and printing money (causing inflation). It destroys the workforce due to high casualties, and blockades cause civilian starvation. This widespread misery destroys public faith in the government, often triggering strikes, mutinies, and political revolutions.
22. An autocracy is a system of government where one person has absolute, unchecked power. Before 1918, this power in Germany was held by Kaiser Wilhelm II, who could make laws and control the army without needing the parliament's approval.
23. Extreme left-wing groups (like Communists) believed in violent revolution to overthrow capitalism and create a society where wealth and property were shared equally. Extreme right-wing groups (like Nationalists/Fascists) believed in strong authoritarian leadership, extreme patriotism, a powerful military, and the destruction of communism.

24. Students should mention: the Allied naval blockade causing starvation, the failure of the final German spring offensive in 1918, the entry of the USA into the war with fresh troops, the Kiel Mutiny, and the ultimate surrender on 11 November 1918.
25. 28 June 1919
26. The War Guilt Clause, forcing Germany to accept total blame for the war
27. £6.6 billion
28. 100,000 men
29. Diktat
30. Rosa Luxemburg and Karl Liebknecht
31. Extreme Left-wing (Communism)
32. January 1919
33. The Freikorps
34. Right-wing private armies made up of demobilised ex-soldiers
35. March 1920
36. The government tried to disband Freikorps units to comply with the Treaty of Versailles limits
37. Because they sympathised with the right-wing rebels
38. They called on the workers of Berlin to launch a General Strike
39. Because Germany had failed to pay its scheduled reparations
40. Passive Resistance

KT1.2: Early Challenges to the Republic, 1919–1923

41. The government printed massive amounts of unbacked paper money to pay the striking workers
42. 201 billion marks
43. The middle classes, because their life savings and fixed pensions became completely worthless
44. People with debts or mortgages
45. Gustav Stresemann
46. The Rentenmark
47. German property / agricultural and industrial land values
48. The Reichsmark
49. 1924
50. The USA
51. It made the entire German economy reliant on American loans
52. The Young Plan
53. From £6.6 billion to £2 billion
54. The Locarno Pact
55. Germany was treated as an equal negotiating partner, not dictated to
56. 1926
57. A seat on the League of Nations Council
58. An international agreement signed by 65 countries to resolve conflicts peacefully rather than using war
59. 12 seats
60. Paul von Hindenburg

KT1.3: The Recovery of the Republic, 1924–1929

61. Farmers and the middle classes who had lost their savings in 1923
62. Unemployment never fell below 1.3 million
63. "Germany is dancing on a volcano."
64. The Wall Street Crash
65. 25%
66. The Unemployment Insurance Act
67. 3%
68. Over 100,000
69. Article 109
70. 32
71. Double-earners

- 72. 100,000
- 73. The 'New Woman' (Neue Frau)
- 74. The removal of pre-war censorship and economic recovery providing funding
- 75. New Objectivity (Neue Sachlichkeit)
- 76. George Grosz and Otto Dix
- 77. The Bauhaus
- 78. Walter Gropius
- 79. "Art and Technology - a new unity"
- 80. Fritz Lang



KT1.4: Changes in Society, 1924–1929

- 81. Marlene Dietrich
- 82. They believed the new culture was immoral, un-German, and undermined traditional family values
- 83. They felt it was an extravagant waste of money when poor workers were still struggling to survive
- 84. The middle classes

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 84 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/84)	Parent/Guardian Signature	Target for Next Time
1				
2				
3				

Operative Reflection

My ultimate strength in this unit is...

The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...